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Ἀβυδηνὸς ὁ ἱστορικός · Abydenus the Historian

On Assyrian and Median History

Ἀποσπάσματα

Period: Ἑλληνιστική Hellenistic

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^{t1-12} ΑΣΣΥΡΙΑΚΑ ΚΑΙ ΜΗΔΙΚΑ. Syncellus: Ἐκ τῶν Ἀβυδηνοῦ Περὶ τῆς τῶν Χαλδαίων βασιλείας .

¹ Χαλδαίων μὲν τῆς σοφίης πέρι τοσαῦτα. Βασιλεῦσαι δὲ τῆς χώρας πρῶτον λέγεται Ἄλωρον, τὸν δὲ ὑπὲρ ἑωυτοῦ λόγον διαδοῦναι ὅτι μιν τοῦ λεῶ ποιμένα ὁ θεὸς ἀποδείξει. Βασιλεῦσαι δὲ σάρους δέκα. Σάρος δὲ ἐστὶν ἑξακόσια καὶ τρισχίλια ἔτεα, νῆρος δὲ ἑξακόσια, σῶσσοι δὲ ἑξήκοντα. Μετὰ δὲ τοῦτον Ἀλάπαρον ἄρξει σάρους τρεῖς, μεθ' ὃν Ἀμίλλαρος ἐκ πόλεως Παντιβίβλιος ἐβασίλευσε σάρους ιγ'. Ἐφ' οὗ δευτέρου Ἀννήδωτον τὴν θάλασσαν ἀναδύναμι παραπλήσιον Ὠάννη τὴν ἰδέαν ἡμιδαίμονα. Μεθ' ὃν Ἀμμένων ἐκ Παντιβίβλων ἤρξε σάρους ιβ'. Μεθ' ὃν Μεγάλαρος ἐκ Παντιβίβλων ἤρξε σάρους ὀκτωκαίδεκα· εἶτα Δαῶς ποιμὴν ἐκ Παντιβίβλων ἐβασίλευσε σάρους δέκα, ἐφ' οὗ δ' διφυεῖς γῆν ἐκ θαλάσσης ἀνέδυσαν, ὧν τὰ ὀνόματα ταῦτα, Εὐέδωκος, Ἐνεύγαμος, Ἐνεύβουλος, Ἀνήμεντος. Ἐπὶ δὲ τοῦ μετὰ ταῦτα Εὐεδωρέσχου Ἀνώδαφος. Μεθ' ὃν ἄλλοι τε ἤρξαν καὶ Σίσουθρος ἐπὶ τούτοις, ὡς τοὺς πάντας εἶναι βασιλεῖς δέκα, ὧν ὁ χρόνος τῆς βασιλείας συνῆξε σάρους ἑκατὸν εἴκοσι. Καὶ περὶ τοῦ κατακλισμοῦ παρόμοια μὲν, οὐκ ἀπαράλλακτα λέγει οὕτως· «Μετὰ Εὐεδωρέσχον ἄλλοι τινὲς ἤρξαν καὶ Σίσιθρος, ὃ δὲ Κρόνος προσημαίνει μὲν ἔσεσθαι πλῆθος ὄμβρων Δαίσιου ἱε'· κελεύει δὲ πᾶν ὅ τι γραμμάτων ἦν ἐχόμενον ἐν Ἡλιουπόλει τῇ ἐν Σισπόροισιν ἀποκρύψαι. Σίσιθρος δὲ ταῦτα ἐπιτελέα ποιήσας, εὐθέως ἐπ' Ἀρμενίης ἀνέπλωε· καὶ παραυτίκα μὲν κατελάμβανε τὰ ἐκ τοῦ θεοῦ· τρίτη δὲ ἡμερὴ ἐπεὶ ὕων ἐκόπασε, μετῴει τῶν ὀρνίθων, πείρην ποιεύμενος εἴ κου γῆν ἴδοιεν τοῦ ὕδατος ἐκδύσαν. Αἱ δὲ ἐκδεκόμενου σφέας πελάγεος ἀμφιχανέος, ἀπορέουσαι ὅκη καθορμίσονται, παρὰ τὸν Σίσιθρον ὀπίσω κομίζονται· καὶ ἐπ' αὐτῇσιν ἔτεραι. Ὡς δὲ τῇσι τρίτησιν εὐτύχεεν (ἀπίκато γὰρ δὴ πηλοῦ κατάπλεοι τοὺς ταρσοὺς), θεοὶ μιν ἐξ ἀνθρώπων ἀφανίζουσι, τὸ δὲ πλοῖον ἐν Ἀρμενίῃ περὶαπτα ξύλων ἀλεξιφάρμακα (καὶ) τοῖσιν ἐπιχωρίοις παρείχετο.

⁵ Ἐντὶ δ' οἱ λέγουσι τοὺς πρῶτους ἀνασχόντας ῥώμη τε καὶ μεγέθει χαυνωθέντας καὶ δὴ θεῶν καταφρονήσαντας ἀμείνονας εἶναι τύρσιν ἡλίβατον ἀείρειν, ἢ νῦν Βαβυλῶν ἐστὶν· ἥδη τε ἄσσον εἶναι τοῦ οὐρανοῦ, καὶ τοὺς ἀνέμους θεοῖσι βωθέοντας ἀνατρέψαι περὶ αὐτοῖσι τὸ μηχανήμα· τοῦ δὲ τὰ ἐρείπια λέγεσθαι Βαβυλῶνα. Τέως δὲ ὄντας ὁμογλώσσους ἐκ θεῶν πολύθροον φωνὴν ἐνέγκασθαι μετὰ δὲ Κρόνῳ καὶ Τιτῇνι συστῆναι πόλεμον.

⁹ And I also found in Abydin's On the Assyrians, a writing about Nebuchadnezzar, this: Heraclius, the most powerful of the great kings, commanded the armies of Libya and Iberia;

but when he had conquered them, he sent them to dwell on the right side of Pontus." Then, it is said to the Chaldeans, as he ascended to the kingdoms seized by God, then behold, he, having risen up, said, This I, Nebuchadnezzar, O Babylonians, foretell you the coming calamity, which neither Belus our ancestor nor the kingdoms of Belus will turn away, nor will Fate persuade the weak. The Persians will be half-hearted, to whom you owe your alliance, and will be enslaved. Where the Medes will be a partner, the Assyrians will be a disgrace. If I were to be able to give the cities, some Charybdis or a sea that is welcome to feel the roots or other paths, to be carried through the desert, so that neither the bones nor the feet of men, but the forests have a law and birds are created, if they either stone or carve only a burnt one; me too, before these things were put into law, would remain perfect and reign. The one you established me has disappeared too soon; but the boy Amilmarudoco reigned. The fourth, the funeral procession of Iglisaris (iq Niriglisaris), is missing a boy named Lavassoarascon. But since he died violently, Nabanidochus is declared king, and no one is suitable. But Cyrus, having come to Babylon, is given the hegemony of Carmani. " And about Nebuchadnezzar building Babylon, he himself writes this: "It is said that everything was from the beginning with water, called the sea. And the sphere * stopped, giving each country a place, and Babylon was surrounded by walls; but in time it was destroyed by the fire. "And Nebuchadnezzar, having built the wall, built a bronze gate until the beginning of the Macedonians." And with another he selects; Nebuchadnezzar, having succeeded in building it, walled Babylon with a triple enclosure in fifteen days, he diverted the Armakale river, which is a branch of the Euphrates, and the Akrahan. And against the city of Sipparene, having dug a ditch, a perimeter of forty parasangs, a depth of twenty bronze ekim, he built gates, the opening of which overlooks the field; they call them echetognomons. He also achieved the coast of the Red Sea and built the city of Teredona against the Arab invasions; he also made kingdoms of trees, hanging paradises of the name.

⁹ Καὶ ταῦτα δέ μοι ἀπὸ τῆς δηλωθείσης κείσθω γραφῆς.

^{10a} After this his son, called Ewelad-Merodach, reigned two years after his father's death, as the Chaldean chroniclers Alexander and Abydin testify, as Josephus and all who follow him agree, in agreement with the divine scripture.